

Sympathetic Wear

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ACM Reference Format:

Junichi Kanebako, Naoya Watabe, Miki Yamamura, Haruki Nakamura, Keisuke Shuto, and Hiroko Uchiyama. 2022. Sympathetic Wear. In *Proceedings of the ACM SIGGRAPH '22 Art Gallery, August 07-11, 2022, Vancouver, BC, Canada*. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 2 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3532837.3534955>

1 PROJECT URL

http://kanejun.com/works_SympatheticWear.html



2 DESCRIPTION OF ARTWORK

In situations where people must maintain physical distance from one another and rely on communication through digital screens, we sometimes feel a sense of absence and loneliness. *Sympathetic Wear* is artwork that supplements communication through digital displays and considers the person on the other side of the network. When we are sad or in pain, the action of having our backs rubbed can provide comfort. Adopting the back as our theme, *Sympathetic Wear* brings gentle healing to people's minds and bodies by creating a soft tactile sensation on the back that is invisible on screen.

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SIGGRAPH '22 Art Gallery, August 07-11, 2022, Vancouver, BC, Canada

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ACM ISBN 978-1-4503-9372-0/22/08.

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3532837.3534955>

The actuator, “expanding leaf,” can create the sensation of pressure by causing a 3D-printed resin leaf to bend through the placement of shape memory alloy wire in a unique design. In this work, one can feel the vitality of plants in the form of a gentle caress and light patting on the back.

As we sit continually facing the screen, we human beings can feel as if we had become a plant with roots growing into the chair. The transformation of human beings from animals into plants is reflected in this work as an image of a tree rooted in the earth. The threads used in the work are perceived as the fibers contained in plants, and by assembling each one by hand we were able to achieve an organic work affording a sense of vitality and warmth.

We hope to bring greater tenderness to our daily lives by deepening the relationships between us, expressing feelings of closeness, compassion and encouragement through the human back.



3 ARTIST INFORMATION

Junichi Kanebako is an interactive artist, haptic designer, and educator based in Kobe, Japan. He graduated from Iwate Prefectural University, where he earned Bachelor of Software and Information Science in 2006, and received Ph.D in Kansei Science from University of Tsukuba in 2016. As an educator, He is currently Associate Processor at Kobe Design University. He is skilled in the expression of works that convert sound into vibration, and his recent works are in the collection of the Nagano Prefectural Art Museum (Japan). <http://www.kanejun.com/>

Naoya Watabe is a contemporary artist, textile designer, and educator. He graduated from the Textile Design Course in the Department of Product and Textile Design at Tama Art University, where he received BFA in 2007. He is currently an assistant professor at the Field of Fashion and Textile at the Joshibi University of Art and Design. <https://naoyawatabe.wixsite.com/mysite>

Miki Yamamura is a researcher and teacher focusing on the design and construction of clothing. She has presented her collaborative research on wearable fashion at international conferences such as 2015 Ace, 2018 DIC and 2020 Augmented Human. She has an Associates of Fine Arts from Joshibi Junior College of Art and Design, and a Master of Arts from Showa Women's University.

Haruki Nakamura is a freelance engineer who builds prototypes for interactive arts and games. He is currently a systems engineer.

Keisuke Shuto is a contemporary artist, space designer, educator and researcher. He is currently an associate professor at Joshibi University of Art and Design in Tokyo. He has received BFA from Nagoya Zokei University of Art and Design, and Master of Media Design from Keio University.

Hiroko Uchiyama is a media artist, educator and researcher. Her artworks have been exhibited worldwide including SIGGRAPH '94 Art Show, SIGGRAPH '99, and in the 2001 and 2003 Art Gallery. She is currently a professor at the Department of Media Art at Joshibi University of Art and Design. She has received a BFA from Joshibi University of Art and Design, and an MFA from Tsukuba University.